

Our Ref: APPBCA-2025-24

Building Resilience Group

21 Nov 2025

See Distribution List

Dear Sir/Madam,

ADVISORY TO TOWN COUNCILS ON REGULAR MAINTENANCE OF BUILDINGS AND RESPONSIBILITIES UNDER THE BUILDING CONTROL ACT 1989 ("BC Act") w.e.f. 1 October 2025 (PREVIOUSLY UNDER BUILDING MAINTENANCE AND STRATA MANAGEMENT ACT ("BMSMA"))

Objective

1. This advisory reminds all Town Councils of your statutory responsibilities to maintain buildings in a safe condition, particularly as they age. Town Councils are reminded of the importance of regular self-inspections beyond the statutory inspection regimes, i.e. Periodic Structural Inspection ("**PSI**") and Periodic Façade Inspection ("**PFI**") under Part 5 of the BC Act.
2. Recent incidents involving dislodgment of building parts, arising from inadequate building maintenance, have created serious public safety concerns. These incidents include structural cracks, concrete deterioration, and various building's exterior features falling from height - such as plaster, cladding panels, air-conditioning units, and roofing materials. Specific examples include: an air-conditioning unit falling from height due to deteriorated timber frames, and extensive fallen spalling concrete at lift landing which are common in older HDB blocks. These recurring maintenance issues highlight ongoing vulnerabilities in building upkeep and pose potentially fatal risks to the public.
3. Town Councils are reminded that moisture ingress and weathering, especially at exposed zones of buildings, accelerate deterioration of building elements. For example, carbonation of concrete accelerates when exposed to moisture and weathering, leading to spalling, and compromises the durability of the concrete. The risks of accelerated deterioration are particularly prevalent in buildings over 30 years old, making this age an important threshold for heightened vigilance and more frequent checks.

Regular Inspection and Maintenance Using Technology

4. Town Councils should conduct self-inspections more regularly, at least once every 6 months, especially for buildings that are 30 years or older. More vigilant checks in moisture-prone or weather-exposed areas of buildings help detect warning signs of deterioration before such

deterioration worsens. Where deterioration is observed, affected features and/or their supports must be promptly repaired, replaced and/or removed through appropriate repair methods and to be supervised by a Professional Engineer, where required, to ensure public safety.

5. In carrying out regular maintenance to prevent incidents, Town Councils are advised to adopt modern technologies such as:

(a) Digital Tools: Use digital inspection tools for visual inspection records and structural scanners when deterioration is detected. Information of these technology companies can be found on IMDA's Innovative Tech Companies Directory at: <https://www.imda.gov.sg>.

(b) Advanced Inspection Methods: Deploy drones and thermal imaging during Inspections to enable early detection of structural and exterior features defects, improve accuracy, and reduce safety risks for personnel working at height.

(c) Accredited Services: The Building and Construction Authority (BCA) encourages Town Councils to engage accredited Unmanned Aircraft Systems (UAS) service providers, with verification available through the Singapore Accreditation Council website at <https://www.sac-accreditation.gov.sg>.

This technology-driven approach aims to enhance maintenance effectiveness whilst improving safety outcomes for both buildings and inspection personnel.

Maintenance Responsibilities and Consequences of Lapses

6. Town Councils remain responsible to ensure effective maintenance of the common property of HDB buildings, and the carrying out of statutory inspections is only one part of such maintenance. Early intervention through preventive maintenance and timely repairs enhances safety and is often more cost-effective.
7. Under BC Act Part 4A with effect from 1 October 2025 (previously under Part 3 of the BMSMA), Town Councils have a statutory duty¹ to ensure that any building or any common property or limited common property, the exterior features and their supports, where these are part of common property of HDB buildings, remain securely fixed to the buildings. Failure to comply with this duty can result in fallen exterior features that may severely injure or kill members of the public. Town Councils that do not ensure exterior features remain securely fixed may be subject to enforcement actions, including composition offers or prosecution. Town Councils may also be exposed to private claims and reputational harm. Town Councils are therefore reminded

¹ Under Section 25H(1) of the BC Act w.e.f. 1 October 2025 (previously under Section 9(1) of the BMSMA), every person responsible must ensure that every exterior feature of a building is kept or maintained in a manner that ensures the exterior features or its support is securely fixed and does not collapse, partly or wholly. Failure to comply with section 25H(1) of the BC Act is an offence and the person responsible shall be liable on conviction to a fine not exceeding \$20,000 or to imprisonment for a term not exceeding 12 months or to both.

to maintain proper records of inspections, cooperate with professionals during maintenance checks, and act swiftly to implement effective rectification when building defects are identified.

Clarification

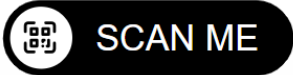
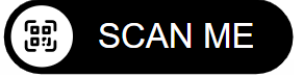
8. Please bring the contents of this advisory to the attention of your personnel and contractors. For clarification, you may submit your enquiry through BCA's Online Feedback Form at <https://www2.bca.gov.sg/feedback/> or call us at 1800 342 5222.

Yours faithfully,



LEE CHEE WEYE
DIRECTOR
BUILDING RESILIENCE GROUP
BUILDING AND CONSTRUCTION AUTHORITY
for COMMISSIONER OF BUILDING CONTROL

Encl.

QR code for BCA Online Feedback Form	QR code for Building Control (Meaning of Exterior Features) Regulations 2021
 	 

Photos of Fallen and Damaged Building Parts, Arising from Inadequate Building Maintenance



Air-Conditioning Unit Falling from Height Due to Deteriorated Timber Frames



Fallen Air-Conditioning Unit



Spalling Concrete at Underside of Sunshade



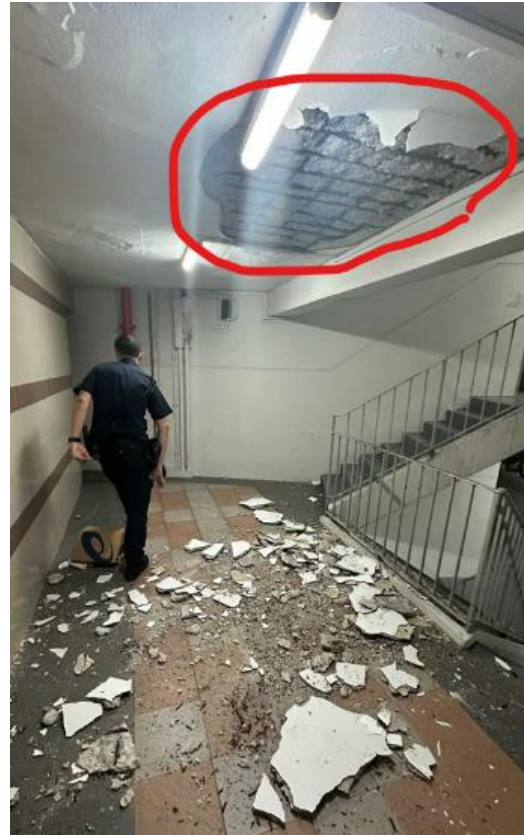
Fallen Piece of Spalling Concrete



Spalling Concrete at Soffit



Fallen Brick Cladding



Extensive Fallen Spalling Concrete at Lift Landing



Cracks on Beam at Voiddeck Area



Re-surfaced Cracks on Column at Lift Lobby due to Inappropriate Repair



Cracks and Spalling at Columns

CIRCULAR DISTRIBUTION LIST (via e-mail)

DISTRIBUTION LIST

All Town Councils for HDB common property